



GENEVA POLO SOCIAL CLUB

Every Guest Has a Name

PLATFORM PROGRESS REPORT

June – August 2026

Prepared for Thierry & the Geneva Polo Club team

The Big Picture

The last report covered the platform learning to run the club's events: pages, ticket sales, a member area, communications. It worked, but it counted **seats**. A booking for four was four places against a limit — the club knew who had paid, and nothing at all about the other three.

Since June the platform has learned to count **people**. Every ticket now belongs to a named person holding their own code for the door. Guests receive their own ticket rather than a forwarded screenshot; they can add a name, correct a spelling, upgrade, cancel, or sign the waiver before they arrive. The door scans a code and shows who has just walked in.

That single change runs through everything below. The door, the guest list, the waiting list, refunds and the finance view all rest upon knowing who is coming rather than how many.

Ten events ran on it in eleven weeks.

1. Every Ticket Belongs to a Named Person

Before: a booking recorded the buyer and a number. Four places meant one name and three strangers. Guests arrived as "plus three", and the club had no way to reach them either before or after.

Now: every seat is a ticket with a holder.

- **Names are required at checkout** — first and last name for every place, not only the buyer's.
- **Each guest receives their own ticket by email**, with their own code. No forwarding a screenshot and hoping.
- **Household bookings stay together** — a couple or family booking on one address receives a single message containing each person's ticket.
- **Guests correct their own details** — a misspelt name or a wrong address is put right by the guest rather than by an administrator.
- **No code, no bracelet** — stated plainly in the ticket email, so guests arrive expecting to be scanned.

What changed for the club: of 543 tickets issued this period, 478 carry a named holder. Those are people the club can recognise at the gate, seat correctly, and contact afterwards — where before there was a number.

2. *The Door Runs on Scans*

Before: door staff worked from a printed list or a phone, matching names by eye and marking people off by hand. A busy gate meant queues and guesswork.

Now: a check-in console built for standing outside in the sun.

- **Scan to admit** — the guest's code is scanned and the screen states who they are and whether they are expected.
- **A live arrivals list**, updating as people come in.
- **The waiver on screen, full size**, signed at the gate by anyone who has not already signed.
- **Guest lists shown separately**, grouped by the member who invited them.
- **A printed sheet as a fallback** — an A to Z roster for doors worked by hand, with leads in bold and their guests indented beneath.
- **Cancelled places no longer appear**, so a refunded seat cannot be admitted by mistake.

Time saved: the door no longer needs someone cross-referencing a list. 180 arrivals were recorded by scan this period, each one landing in the club's records at the moment it happened.

3. *Guests Manage Their Own Booking*

Before: every change passed through an administrator. A name to correct, a guest swapped, an extra place wanted — all of it arrived by message and was done by hand.

Now: each booking has its own page, and so does each ticket.

- **Name or rename a place**, up to the moment of the event.
- **See every ticket in the booking**, with each person's code.
- **Sign the waiver in advance**, so the gate moves faster.
- **Cancel a place**, which frees the seat for someone else immediately.

Time saved: the administrator is no longer the route through which every small change must pass. Corrections that were once a message and a manual edit now happen without anyone at the club being involved.

4. *Buying More, and Moving Up*

Before: a guest wanting an extra place, or a better ticket, had to book again separately or ask for an invoice.

Now: both happen from the booking itself.

- **Add places to an existing booking** — paid for immediately, tickets issued at once.
- **Upgrade a ticket** and pay only the difference.
- **One price everywhere** — the rate a person sees when booking, adding or upgrading comes from a single source, so a member rate remains a member rate throughout.
- **An itemised receipt** on the confirmation, showing what was bought at what price.

5. *The Waiting List Now Sells*

Before: the waiting list collected names. When a place freed up, someone had to notice, choose a person, write to them, and take payment separately.

Now: the club sends a paid offer.

- **Offer a place to a named person** on the list, with a link that lets them pay and claim it.
- **The offer is theirs alone** — it cannot be forwarded and used by someone else.
- **The system refuses to over-promise** — offers are blocked once an event is full, with a warning before an administrator may create one regardless.

What changed for the club: a returned ticket becomes revenue rather than an empty seat, and the sequence runs without anyone tracking who was asked first.

6. *Guest Lists and Complimentary Places*

Before: complimentary guests were a workaround — a free booking made by hand, with no record of who had invited whom.

Now: guest lists are a proper part of an event.

- **Add a guest list against an event**, with places allocated to named guests.
- **The door sees them grouped by sponsor**, so it is clear who invited whom.
- **The roster shows how each seat was obtained** — bought, complimentary, or from the guest list.

- **The complimentary share is visible** in the event overview, rather than hidden inside the headcount.

7. Money in One Place

Before: income was visible as individual payments. Working out what an event had made, or what a member had paid, meant assembling it by hand.

Now: a finance area, with its own access level so a treasurer may see the money without seeing everything else.

- **Membership and event income together**, by month and by season.
- **Refunds issued from the platform**, and deducted from the figures rather than sitting outside them.
- **Cancellations release the seat immediately** and are recorded as refundable.
- **Referral credit per originator**, with a monthly breakdown and a link through to the payment behind each figure.
- **Date paid** shown against each member.

What changed for the club: 110 paid bookings and CHF 14,185 of event income this period, visible in one place rather than reconstructed from receipts.

8. Less to Go Wrong

Not everything worth doing adds a feature. Four things were removed this period, each of them a source of confusion or of mistakes.

- **Children's tickets** — a separate ticket type with its own rules and its own gate at the door. Every ticket now carries a name and a waiver regardless of age, which is both simpler and safer.
- **Ticket forwarding** — passing a ticket to someone else was a second way of doing what naming a guest already does, and it produced tickets nobody could account for.
- **Public self-check-in** — guests checking themselves in from their phones meant arrivals the door had not seen. Check-in is now the door's business alone.
- **Two ways to buy** — buying a ticket and adding one to an existing booking followed separate paths. They now share one, so a change to pricing or rules applies to both.

What changed for the club: fewer paths through the same task means fewer ways for a guest to end up in a state nobody planned for.

9. Behind the Scenes

Work that never appears on a screen, and matters most when it is absent.

- **Member data closed off.** Several records holding member names and addresses could be read by anyone who knew where to look. That is closed, everywhere, and verified.
- **Faults report themselves.** Errors in the live platform now arrive with enough detail to find the cause.
- **The build no longer depends on an outside service** being available at the moment it runs.
- **Signing in works with iPhone's code autofill**, which had been failing silently.
- **Twenty-one changes to the live system** that had been applied without being recorded were recovered and written down, so the platform's history is complete again.

By the Numbers

1 June to 18 August 2026

Events run on the platform	10
Tickets issued	543
Tickets carrying a named holder	478
Arrivals scanned at the door	180
Paid bookings	110
Event income	CHF 14,185
Complimentary and guest-list places	162
New members	26
Changes released	123
Database changes	62

What This Sets Up

Every improvement above rests upon the same foundation: the club now knows, by name, who came to what. That is the raw material for the next stage — following up with the guests who attended, understanding how many of them join, and turning a crowd into members rather than a headcount.

The roadmap covers that ground separately.